

Will Handley

Summary

willhandley.co.uk/CV

Cosmologist and statistician whose research programme weaves theory, observation & inference, accelerated by GPU computing and AI-augmented development:

- Internationally recognised research programme which has been awarded over **£5m** in funding.
- Interdisciplinary research with technology transfer to industry, government & start-ups.
- 2 years experience lecturing fourth-year Cambridge Relativistic Astrophysics & Cosmology and Bayesian inference courses.
- 10 years experience (co-)supervising 40 Masters students, 11 PhD completions & 8 postdocs.
- 160 papers

Nested sampling; GPU-accelerated Bayesian inference; simulation-based inference; cosmological model selection, parameter estimation & tension quantification; dark energy; CMB; 21cm; gravitational waves; supernovae; strong lensing.

Education

- 2012–2016 **University of Cambridge**, *PhD Astrophysics*, Prof. A. Lasenby & Prof. M. Hobson
2008–2012 **University of Cambridge**, *MSci, MA: Natural Sciences*, Gonville & Caius College
2001–2008 **Alleyn's School**, *A levels, GCSEs*, London

Employment & Research

- Oct 2024– **Associate Professor**, *Institute of Astronomy*, University of Cambridge
Oct 2020– **Royal Society University Research Fellow**, *IoA*, University of Cambridge
Bayesian machine learning and tensions in cosmology (Cavendish Lab 2020–2024)
May 2021– **Teaching Fellow**, *Gonville & Caius College*, University of Cambridge
2017– **Chief Technical Officer**, *PolyChord Ltd*, polychord.co.uk
2021–2023 **Turing Fellow**, *Alan Turing Institute*
2016–2020 **Research fellow**, *Gonville & Caius College*, University of Cambridge
Funded by Gonville & Caius College and an STFC IPS grant.
Jul-Sep 2016 **Postdoctoral researcher**, *Prof. H. Peiris*, University College London
Searching for features in the primordial power spectrum.
2012–2016 **PhD Astrophysics**, *Prof. A. Lasenby & Prof. M. Hobson*, University of Cambridge
Kinetic initial conditions for inflation: Theory, observations & methods.
2011–2012 **Part III Dissertation**, *Prof. P. Alexander*, University of Cambridge
Investigating the origins of cosmic magnetism.
Summer 2011 **Summer Research Student**, *Prof. M. Faulkes & Dr. J. Spencer*, Imperial College
Folded spectrum full configuration interaction quantum Monte Carlo.
Summer 2011 **Summer Research Student**, *Dr. R. Blumenfeld*, University of Cambridge
Geometry and field equations of granular systems.
2010–2011 **Research Review**, *Prof. S. Gull*, University of Cambridge
Literature Survey of the Physics-Philosophy crossover field of measurement theory.
Summer 2010 **iGEM Team Physicist**, *Dr. J. Haseloff*, University of Cambridge
E-glowli 2010 iGEM team (placed in final 6) <http://2010.igem.org/Team:Cambridge>

Grants won (£5m)

Cosmology

- £690k **Royal Society URF Renewal 2025**, *Resolving the Universe with Scientific AI*
- £1.3m **ERC starting grant** ⇒ **UKRI frontier research**, *Resolving cosmological tensions with diverse data, novel theories and Bayesian machine learning*
Oct 2024 willhandley.co.uk/ERC.pdf
- £240k **Royal Society Enhancement 2023**, *Next generation nested sampling for cosmological inference*
- £170k **Royal Society Enhancement 2021**, *Likelihood-free inference and Bayesian neural networks*
- £723k **Royal Society URF 2020**, *Bayesian machine learning and tensions in cosmology*
- 95kGPUh **DiRAC RAC 18th call 2026**, *GPU-Accelerated Gravitational Wave Inference*
- 16.1MCPUh **DiRAC RAC 17th call 2025**, *New Horizons in Cosmology: Machine Learning and Inference for the Next Era of Data Analysis*
≡ £161k
- 200kGPUh **AIRR Early Access allocation**, *Alnstein: a limited time-window trained LLM for (re)formulating modern physics*
≡ £80k
- 10kGPUh **AIRR Gateway allocation**, *Alnstein: Time-limited LLM for Historical Scientific Reasoning*
≡ £4k
- 10kGPUh **AIRR Gateway allocation**, *GPU-Accelerated Bayesian Inference for CMB Cosmology*
≡ £4k
- 10kGPUh **AIRR Gateway allocation**, *AI Agents for Scientific Discovery*
≡ £4k
- 52MCPUh **DiRAC RAC 15th call 2023**, *New frontiers in particle cosmology*
≡ £520k
- 30MCPUh **DiRAC RAC 13th call 2021**, *Next generation cosmological analysis with nested sampling*
≡ £300k
- 2MCPUh **DiRAC directors discretionary 2020**, *Bayesian model comparison of inflation and spatial curvature*
≡ £20k
 - £3k **Google Cloud compute award**, *GPU nested sampling research*
 - £15k **KICC Workshop 2023**, *GAMBIT at the KICC*
 - \$6k **George Southgate Visiting Fellowship 2020**, *GAMBIT visit*
 - £15k **KICC Workshop 2019**, *AstroHackWeek 2019*
 - £2k **KICC visitors 2019**, *Likelihood free inference workshop*
 - £2k **KICC visitors 2017**, *Class and MontePython workshop*

PolyChord

- £260k **MSCA DTN 2023**, *GLITTER: Gnss-r satellite earth observation*, PC Ltd et al
- £100k **DASA GAN 2023**, *Optimal dynamic manoeuvring & adaptation of communications networks*, PC Ltd
 - £25k **DSTL CEME 2023**, *MIDAS: Maximum information data acquisition strategies*, PC Ltd
- £100k **DSTL CEME 2022**, *Further optimisation of sensor location*, PC Ltd & QML
- £60k **DSTL CEME 2021**, *Optimisation of sensor location*, PC Ltd & QML
- £10k **DSTL CEME 2020**, *Optimising search route for constrained network discovery*
- £50k **Amadeus Seed capital**, *PolyChord for protein folding*, PC Ltd
- £225k **STFC IPS 2019**, *PolyChord and Bayesian sparse facial recognition*
- £42k **STFC IAA 2018**, *PolyChord and Bayesian neural network facial recognition*
- £25k **STFC IAA 2016**, *Interfacing PolyChord 2.0*

Awards & Prizes

Jul. 2022	Pacific Institute of Theoretical Physics visitor	<i>University of British Columbia</i>
Feb. 2020	George Southgate visiting Fellow	<i>University of Adelaide</i>
Jul. 2019	Guiseppe and Vanna Cocconi Prize (WMAP and Planck)	<i>EPS-HEPP Division</i>
Dec. 2013	Best presentation	<i>Cavendish grad. students conference</i>
Jun. 2012	Best theoretical part III project	<i>University of Cambridge</i>
	Physics prize	<i>Gonville & Caius College</i>
Summer 2011	Undergraduate Research Bursary	<i>Nuffield Foundation</i>
	UROP Studentship	<i>Imperial College</i>
Summer 2010	iGEM Studentship	<i>Wellcome Trust</i>
2009–12	Junior and Senior Scholarships	<i>Gonville & Caius College</i>

Current students & postdocs

handley-lab.co.uk/group

Postdoc	Chris Lovell, Natalie Hogg, Matt Grayling	2025-present
	David Yallup	2021-present
PhD	Charlotte Priestley, Lawrence Berry	2025-present
	Toby Lovick	2024-present
	Namu Kroupa, Dily Ong, Sam Leeney	2023-present
	Metha Prathaban, Wei-Ning Deng, Sinah Legner	2022-present
Masters	Rose Luo, Alex Drane, Farah Wallauer	2025-present

Previous students & postdocs

PhD

- Sep 2025 **Adam Ormondroyd**, *Bayesian methods in a flexible universe: sampling, tension and dark energy*
co-supervised with Mike Hobson and Anthony Lasenby
- Aug 2024 **Kilian Scheutwinkel**, *Simulation-based Bayesian machine learning methods for Cosmology and beyond*
co-supervised with Eloy de Lera Acedo
- Aug 2024 **George Carter**, *The Bayesian Global Sky Model (B-GSM)*
co-supervised with Nima Razavi-Ghods & Mark Ashdown
- Mar 2024 **Thomas Gessey-Jones**, *Probing the First Stars with the 21-cm Signal: Theory, Methods, and Forecasts*
co-supervised with Eloy de Lera Acedo & Anastasia Fialkov
- Dec 2023 **Ian Roque**, *EXCALIBRATE: Calibration for astrophysical experimentation*
co-supervised with Nima Razavi-Ghods
- Jun 2023 **Harry Bevens**, *A Machine Learning-enhanced Toolbox for Bayesian 21-cm Data Analysis and Constraints on the Astrophysics of the Early Universe*
co-supervised with Eloy de Lera Acedo and Anastasia Fialkov
- Jul 2022 **Dominic Anstey**, *Data Analysis in Global 21cm Experiments: Physically Motivated Bayesian Modelling Techniques*
co-supervised with Eloy de Lera Acedo
- Sep 2021 **Fruzsina Agocs**, *Primordial evolution of cosmological perturbations: Theory and computation*
co-supervised with Mike Hobson & Anthony Lasenby
- Aug 2021 **Will Barker**, *Gauge Theories of Gravity*
co-supervised with Mike Hobson & Anthony Lasenby
- Dec 2020 **Lukas Hergt**, *Constraining the kinetically dominated Universe*
co-supervised with Mike Hobson & Anthony Lasenby
- Oct 2018 **Ed Higson**, *Bayesian Methods and machine Learning in Astrophysics*
co-supervised final year with Mike Hobson & Anthony Lasenby
- Individual projects Thomas McAloon (2020-21), Isidro Gómez Vargas (2020), Ayngaran Thavenesan (2021-22)

MPhil

- Sep 2023 **Danielle Dineen**, *Cosmological Matching Conditions for Primordial Perturbations*
- Jan 2023 **Allahyar Sahibzada**, *Machine Learning and Nested Sampling: in the context of data intensive science and cosmology*
- Nov 2022 **Sam Leeney**, *Data science in early universe Cosmology: a novel Bayesian RFI mitigation approach using numerical sampling techniques*
co-supervised with Eloy de Lera Acedo

- Aug 2020 **Emma Shen**, *Ionospheric Effects in the Global 21-cm Experiment*
co-supervised with Eloy de Lera Acedo & Anastasia Fialkov
- Aug 2019 **Ian Roque**, *Bayesian Techniques for the Calibration of 21 cm Global Experiments*
co-supervised with Nima Razavi-Ghods
- Aug 2018 **Panagiotis Mavrogiannis**, *Wheeler–Feynman absorber theory of radiation: Establishing the cosmological electrodynamic arrow of time*
co-supervised with Anthony Lasenby

MSci

- 2025 Harvey Williams, Krish Nanavati, Ming Yang, Will Templeton, Charlotte Priestley
- 2024 Nicolas Mediato Diaz, Samuel Hewson, Felicity Ibrahim, Patrick Lau, Tze Goh
- 2023 Zixiao Hu, Cole Meldorf, Sankalan Bhattacharyyan, Toby Lovick
- 2022 Yoann Launay, Oliver Normand, Xy Wang, Carola Zanoletti
- 2021 Yi Jer Loh, Metha Prathaban
- 2020 Thomas Gessey-Jones, Aleks Petrosyan
- 2019 Deaglan Bartlet, Jamie Bamber, Ian Roque
- 2018 Ward Haddadin, Jessica Rigley
- 2017 Fruzsina Agocs, Robert Knighton, Stephen Pickman, Daniel Manela

Summer students

- 2025 Fedir Boreiko, Ajinkya Naik
- 2024 Charlotte Priestley
- 2023 Zixiao Hu, Toby Lovick, Namu Kroupa
- 2022 Mary Letey, Beichen Xu, Artyom Baryshnikov
- 2021 Zak Shumaylov, Mattia Varrone
- 2019 Denis Werth, Maxime Jabarian, Liam Lau
- 2018 Elizabeth Guest, Ward Haddadin, Shu-Fan Chen

Postdocs

- 2025 Jiamin Hou
- 2024 George Carter, Thomas Gessey-Jones
- 2018-19 Kamran Javid

Lecturing

- 2021-2023 Part III Physics: Relativistic Astrophysics & Cosmology *MSci 24 lecture course*
- 2017-2021 Bayesian Statistics *Graduate 2 lecture course*

Workshops

- 2025 **GPU-native nested sampling in BlackJAX**, *For simulation-based inference at scale*, SBI Galaxy Evolution 2025, Bristol
github.com/handley-lab/workshop-blackjax-nested-sampling
- 2025 **AI/ML Tools for Research**, *KICC Workshop*, July 2025
- 2025 **An Introduction to Artificial Intelligence and Large Language Models, Part II/III students**, February 2025
docs.google.com/presentation
- 2023 **Monte Carlo Methods**, *For Cosmology and Particle Physics*, UNAM, Mexico
github.com/handley-lab/workshop-monte-carlo-methods
- 2022 **ICCS**, *Training Machine Learning models*, Cambridge, UK
github.com/handley-lab/2022-cambridge-iccs

- 2018 **CosmoTools**, *Introduction to Statistics*, Aachen, Germany
indico.cern.ch/e/CosmoTools2018
- 2017 **CosmoTools**, *Cosmological statistics & sampling*, IFT Madrid, Spain
workshops.ift.uam-csic.es/cosmotools2017

Small group teaching

2026–present	Part II Physics: Topics in Astrophysics	Supervising
2023–present	Part II Physics: Statistical Mechanics	Supervising (45 hours)
2022–present	Part II Physics: Astrophysical Fluid Dynamics	Supervising (36 hours)
2020–2022	Part III Physics: Relativistic Astrophysics and Cosmology	Supervising (47 hours)
2013–present	Part II Physics: General relativity	Supervising (176 hours)
2012–2017	Part IA Mathematics for NatSci	Tripas classes (20 hours), Supervising (487 hours)
2015–2016	Part IA Physics	Supervising (20 hours)
2013	Part II Theoretical Physics 1 & 2	Demonstrating (8 hours)
2006–2012	Maths and Science Tuition	Individual coaching, key stage 1 – STEP

Academic Talks

willhandley.co.uk/talks

† = remote

- Mar. 2026 **Classical inference at scale: dark energy, tensions, and the GPU revolution**, *CosmoVerse 2026*
- Feb. 2026 **The New Scientific Method**, *IoA Colloquium*, Cambridge, UK
- Jan. 2026 **Two Revolutions: GPUs for Science, AI for Scientists**, *Imperial College London*, UK
- Dec. 2025 **AI/ML Tools for Research**, *GAMBIT LLMBit Workshop*, Oslo, Norway
- Oct. 2025 **GPU Accelerated Bayesian Inference for Astronomy**, *University of Birmingham*, UK
- Sep. 2025 **Next-Generation Model Comparison for Primordial Cosmology**, *LMU Munich*, Munich, Germany
- Jul. 2025 **A Statistician's Guide to the Galaxy (Fitting Zoo)**, *Future of SED Fitting Workshop*, Cambridge, UK
- Jun. 2025 **GPU Accelerated Nested Sampling**, *Newton Institute workshop*, Cambridge, UK
- Jun. 2025 **lsbi: linear simulation based inference**, *EUCAIFCON 2025*, Sardinia
- May. 2025 **GPU-native nested sampling in BlackJAX: For simulation-based inference at scale**, *SBI Galaxy Evolution 2025*, Bristol
- May. 2025 **Scanning for cosmological tensions across a DiRAC-enabled grid of models, datasets and samplers**, *Cosmoverse 2025*, Italy
- Jan. 2025 **GPU Accelerated Nested Sampling for 21-cm Cosmology**, *Caltech*, US
- Jan. 2025 **Cosmological tensions? A guide for high energy theorists**, *DAMTP HEP group*, Cambridge, UK
- Jan. 2025 **Theory meets experiment 2025: New frontiers in particle cosmology**, *Rencontres du Vietnam*, Quy Nhon, Vietnam
- Dec. 2024 **Next-generation statistical inference tools: Simulation-based inference, marginal statistics & accelerated nested sampling**, *Towards a realistic detection of Primordial Gravitational Wave Backgrounds*, Madrid, Spain
- Oct. 2024 **PolySwyft: a sequential simulation-based nested sampler**, *Global 21cm workshop 2024*, Raman Research Institute, Bangalore, India
- Sep. 2024 **lsbi: linear simulation based inference**, *PhyStat: Statistics meets ML*, Imperial college London, UK

- Aug. 2024 **Nested sampling: powering next-generation inference and machine learning tools for astrophysics, cosmology, particle physics and beyond**, *University of Sydney*, Sydney, Australia
- Aug. 2024 **Sampling methods for high energy physics & particle astrophysics**, *XVIth Quark Confinement and the Hadron Spectrum*, Cairns, Australia
- Aug. 2024 **Nested sampling: powering next-generation inference and machine learning tools for astrophysics, cosmology, particle physics and beyond**, *University of Queensland*, Brisbane, Australia
- Jul. 2024 **Nested sampling: powering next-generation inference and machine learning tools for astrophysics, cosmology, particle physics and beyond**, *RWTH*, Aachen, Germany
- Jul. 2024 **PolySwyft: a sequential simulation-based nested sampler**, *CosmoVerse 2024*, Krakow, Poland
- Jul. 2024 **The scaling frontier of nested sampling**, *MaxEnt 2024*, Ghent, Belgium
- Jun. 2024 **Resonant or asymmetric: The status of sub-GeV dark matter**, *Dark Matter in Astrophysical Laboratories*, Cambridge, UK
- May. 2024 **Next generation astrophysical inference across the interdisciplinary frontier**, *UCL job talk*, UCL, UK[†]
- May. 2024 **PolySwyft: a sequential simulation-based nested sampler**, *PhyStat 2024*, CERN, Switzerland
- Apr. 2024 **Next generation astrophysical inference across the interdisciplinary frontier**, *IoA job talk*, Cambridge, UK
- Mar. 2024 **Nested sampling: powering next-generation inference and machine learning tools for astrophysics, cosmology, particle physics and beyond**, *Gatsby computational neuroscience unit*, UCL, UK
- Feb. 2024 **Sampling techniques in high-dimensional parameter spaces with ScannerBit 2.0**, *ORIGINS data science cluster*, Munich, Germany
- Jan. 2024 **Next-generation inference tools for cosmology and beyond**, Oxford, UK
- Jan. 2024 **Simulation Based Inference: theory, sampling & model comparison**, *RAS*, London, UK
- Dec. 2023 **Nested sampling: powering next-generation inference and machine learning tools for astrophysics, cosmology, particle physics and beyond**, *UNAM*, Mexico City, Mexico
- Nov. 2023 **Bayesian OODA loops with MIDAS: Augmented decision making in a complex future electromagnetic environment**, *OFEME 2023*, Nottingham, UK
- Oct. 2023 **unimpeded: Universal model comparison and parameter estimation distributed over every dataset**, *Oscar Klein Center*, Stockholm, Sweden
- Oct. 2023 **Nested sampling: powering next-generation inference and machine learning tools for cosmology, particle physics and beyond**, *Manchester*, UK
- Sep. 2023 **Nested sampling tools**, *REACH AGM*, Malta
- Sep. 2023 **Nested sampling: powering next-generation inference and machine learning tools for cosmology, particle physics and beyond**, *UCL*, UK
- Aug. 2023 **Nested sampling: powering next-generation inference and machine learning tools for cosmology, particle physics and beyond**, *KCL*, UK
- Jul. 2023 **The scaling frontier of nested sampling: Summary talk**, *MaxEnt*, Munich, Germany
- Jun. 2023 **Gradients and Nested Sampling: the present state of the art**, *MIAPbP*, Munich, Germany
- Mar. 2023 **Nested Sampling: A multi-purpose numerical tool for science and machine learning**, *ETH Zurich*, Switzerland

- Jan. 2023 **Nested sampling: powering the next-generation of Bayesian inference tools for cosmology, particle physics and beyond**, *Cavendish job talk*, Cambridge, UK
- Jan. 2023 **High dimensional nested sampling**, *Simulation based inference with swyft*, Amsterdam, Netherlands
- Jan. 2023 **What is the benefit of adversarial systems?**, *Mathematical Challenges in the Electromagnetic Environment*, London, UK
- Dec. 2022 **Theory, observation & cosmological inference**, *KICC christmas*, Cambridge, UK
- Sep. 2022 **Next generation cosmological analysis with nested sampling**, *KICC Symposium*, Cambridge, UK
- Sep. 2022 **Next generation cosmological analysis with nested sampling**, *Corfu2022: Tensions in Cosmology*, Corfu, Greece
- Aug. 2022 **Dark matter, cosmology and likelihood-free Inference**, *GAMBIT XIV*, Kelowna, Canada
- Jul. 2022 **Nested Sampling: An efficient and robust Bayesian inference tool for particle physics and cosmology**, *TRIUMF & UBC*, Vancouver, Canada
- Jul. 2022 **Frontiers of Nested Sampling**, *MaxEnt 2022*, Paris, France
- Apr. 2022 **Nested Sampling and Likelihood-free inference**, *Likelihood-free in Paris*, Paris, France
- Apr. 2022 **Statistical methods in Cosmology**, *Obs. and Theor. 21-cm Cosmology*, Cambridge, UK
- Jan. 2022 **PolyChord: Next generation nested sampling**, *UK Atomic Energy Authority*, UK[†]
- Nov. 2021 **Review on Statistical Tools and Samplers**, *TOOLS 2021*, IP2I, Lyon, France[†]
- Jul. 2021 **Success Story 2 — Optimum Sensor Placement**, *Mathematical Challenges in the Electromagnetic Environment*, Isaac Newton Institute, Cambridge, UK
- Jul. 2021 **Success Story 1 — Detecting Illicit Mesh Networks**, *Mathematical Challenges in the Electromagnetic Environment*, Isaac Newton Institute, Cambridge, UK
- Mar. 2021 **PolyChord: Novel Bayesian Machine Learning**, *Cambridge Data Science Fair*, UK[†]
- Feb. 2021 **Bayesian methods for quantifying global parameter tensions between cosmological datasets**, *Tehran meeting on cosmology at the crossroads*, Tehran, Iran[†]
- Jan. 2021 **Bayesian information fusion**, *Mathematical Challenges in the Electromagnetic Environment*, Isaac Newton Institute, Cambridge, UK[†]
- Oct. 2020 **Nested Sampling: an efficient and robust Bayesian inference tool for 21cm cosmology**, *3rd Global 21-cm Workshop*, Cambridge, UK[†]
- Sep. 2020 **Nested Sampling for optimising sensor location**, *Mathematical Challenges in the Electromagnetic Environment*, Isaac Newton Institute, Cambridge, UK[†]
- Feb. 2020 **Nested Sampling: an efficient and robust Bayesian inference tool for physics and machine learning**, *Physics Colloquium*, Adelaide, Australia
- Jan. 2020 **Nested Sampling: an efficient and robust Bayesian inference tool for astrophysics and cosmology**, Oxford, UK
- Jan. 2020 **PolyChord: next generation nested sampling**, *Mathematical Challenges in the Electromagnetic Environment*, Isaac Newton Institute, Cambridge, UK
- Dec. 2019 **Quantised primordial power spectra**, *Texas 2019*, Portsmouth, UK
- Nov. 2019 **Nested Sampling: an efficient and robust Bayesian inference tool for Machine Learning and Data Science**, *CDT talk*, Cambridge, UK
- Aug. 2019 **Curvature tension: evidence for a closed universe(?)**, *ICG Portsmouth*, UK
- Jul. 2019 **Quantifying cosmological tensions**, University College London, UK
- Jun. 2019 **Likelihood free inference**, *GAMBIT X*, Germany
- Mar. 2019 **Compromise-free Bayesian sparse reconstruction**, *LFI workshop*, Flatiron institute, US
- Dec. 2018 **Inflation, curvature and kinetic dominance**, *Future uses of Planck data*, ESAC, Spain

- Nov. 2018 **BAMBI Resurrection: Blind Accelerated Multimodal Bayesian Inference**, *Dark Machines*, Worldwide[†]
- Nov. 2018 **Nested Sampling: an efficient and robust Bayesian inference tool for cosmology and particle physics**, *Dark Machines*, Worldwide[†]
- Oct. 2018 **Bayesian Statistics**, *Third Asterics-Obelics workshop*, Cambridge, UK
- May. 2018 **Planck, inflation and the future of inflationary constraints**, *Consistency of Cosmological Datasets*, Cambridge, UK
- May. 2018 **MaxEnt priors with derived parameters in a specified distribution**, Cambridge, UK
- May. 2018 **Nested Sampling: an efficient and robust Bayesian inference tool for astrophysics and cosmology**, ICIC, UK
- April. 2018 **Introduction to statistics**, *CosmoTools 18*, RWTH Aachen, Germany
- Jan. 2018 **Advances in Nested Sampling & astrophysical application**, Cambridge, UK
- Aug. 2017 **PolyChord 2.0: Fast inference & nested sampling**, *Cosmo17*, Paris, France
- Jun. 2017 **Modern Bayesian Inference: Theory and Practice**, RWTH Aachen, Germany
- Mar. 2017 **Parameter estimation and Model comparison**, *CosmoTools 17*, Madrid, Spain
- Feb. 2017 **PolyChord 2.0: Advances in Nested Sampling & astrophysical application**, Flatiron institute, US
- Sep. 2016 **PolyChord 2.0 & the future of nested sampling**, University College London, UK
- May. 2016 **PolyChord 2.0 & the future of nested sampling**, University of Sussex, UK
- Mar. 2016 **PolyChord & the future of nested sampling**, Edinburgh, UK
- Dec. 2015 **PolyChord: next generation nested sampling**, *MPA Bayes Forum*, Munich, Germany
- Feb. 2015 **PolyChord: next generation nested sampling**, University of Sussex, UK
- Dec. 2013 **Kinetic dominance in the pre-inflationary universe**, Cavendish grad. conference

Outreach

- 7 Nov 2025 **AI and the Future of Scientific Discovery**, *IoA Alumni Event*, Institute of Astronomy
- 17 Feb 2025 **Precision Cosmology: new scientific windows on the Universe**, *Sherrington Society*, Gonville & Caius College
- 25 Oct 2023 **Tensions in the Universe: a crisis in precision cosmology?**, *Cambridge University Physics Society*, Cambridge
- 24 Oct 2023 **Tensions in the Universe: a crisis in precision cosmology?**, *Thomas Young Club*, Emmanuel College
- 31 Oct 2022 **The James Webb Telescope**, *Sherrington Society*, Gonville & Caius College
- 11 Feb 2019 **Cosmology: A Scientist's History of the Universe**, *Sherrington Society*, Gonville & Caius College
- 21 Sep 2018 **Observing the big bang: A short history of nearly nothing**, *Public talk*, Belgium
- 2 May 2017 **Observing the Big Bang: a short history of nearly nothing**, *Gonville & Caius College*, Cambridge
- Apr 2016 **Cosmology: from CMB to astrophysics**, *Kavli Institute for Cosmology*, Cambridge
- 18 May 2016 **Cosmology**, *Intro to Astronomy course*, Cambridge
- 1 Jul 2015 **The Physics of Juggling**, *Senior Physics Challenge*, Churchill College
- 27 May 2015 **Intro. to Astronomy: Beyond the Milky Way**, *IoA Public Talk*, Cambridge
- 20 May 2015 **To infinity and beyond: Dark Energy**, *Pint of Science*, Cambridge Brewhouse
- 14 Jan 2015 **The Cosmic Microwave Background: our probe of the birth of the universe**, *IoA Public Evening*, Cambridge

2018–2020 Education and research committee
2017–2022 Organiser of weekly group seminars

Gonville & Caius college
Cavendish astrophysics group

Examination

2024– **Senior Examiner**, *Astrophysics*, Part II
2024– **CATAM coordinator**, *Astrophysics*, Part II
2021–2023 **Exam setting**, *Relativistic Astrophysics and Cosmology*, Part III Physics
2020–2022 **Masters exam checking**, *Astrostatistics*, Part III Maths

PhD

2025 **Emilie Hertig**, *Probes of cosmic inflation: from the CMB to quantum analogues*
Jul 2025 **Matthew Craigie**, *Interpretable and Physically-Motivated Deep Learning Solutions for Large-Scale Structure Cosmology*
May 2024 **Stefan Heimersheim**, *Constraining reionization: Evidence from 21 cm limits and predictions for fast radio bursts*
Dec 2023 **Lester Sandles**, *Star-forming Galaxies and Quenched Systems throughout Cosmic Time*
Dec 2021 **Wu Hyun Sohn**, *High-resolution CMB bispectrum estimator*

First year reports (probationary reviews)

Sep 2025 **Mohammad-Hadi Sotoudeh**
Aug 2025 **Edward Stevenson**
Nov 2023 **Yuchen Liu**
Mar 2023 **Dily Ong**
Aug 2022 **Yu Hsuan Shen**

Second year reports

Jul 2025 **Alexander Byrne**

MPhil

Sep 2020 **Kyriakos Stylianiopoulos**, *Machine Learning Applied to Gaia and Other Survey Data: Applications Supporting a Polarisation Survey*

Organisation of scientific meetings

2025	LoC member for IOP Joint APP and HEPP Annual Conference 2025	<i>Cavendish</i>
2024	Cosmological Inference in High Dimension	<i>KICC</i>
2023	GAMBIT at the KICC	<i>KICC</i>
2023	Frontiers of nested sampling	<i>Munich</i>
2023	Simulation based inference workshop (delayed from 2019)	<i>KICC</i>
2020	Scientific organising committee member of 3 rd Global 21-cm Workshop	<i>KICC</i>
2019	Local organising committee member of KICC 10 th anniversary symposium	<i>KICC</i>
2019	Helped secure funding and organised AstroHack week 2019	<i>KICC</i>
2018	Secured funding for and organised CLASS+MontePython software workshop	<i>KICC</i>

Peer review

Performed 86 reviews for journals including Physical Review D and Physical Review Letters;

<https://www.webofscience.com/wos/author/rid/S-9134-2018>

PRD (37), PRL (9), JCAP (8), MNRAS (7), PLB (6), Entropy (4), JOSS (2), APJ (2), Astronomy & Computing (2), Physics of the Dark Universe (2), RASTI (2), A&A (1), EPJC (1)

Review for fellowship awards:

- 2022 C2D3 Early Career Researcher Seed Fund
- 2022 ABTA UK Doctoral Research Award
- 2022 Blavatnik fellowship
- 2021– Gonville & Caius Junior Research Fellowships

Collaborations

- 2018–present REACH *astro.phy.cam.ac.uk/research/research-projects/reach*
- 2018–present GAMBIT *gambit.hepforge.org*
- 2018–2020 DarkMachines *darkmachines.org*
- 2017–2018 Terra Hunter Experiment *terrahunting.org*
- 2016–2017 CORE *core-mission.org*
- 2015–2016 AMI *astro.phy.cam.ac.uk/research/research-projects/AMI*
- 2015–2019 Planck *cosmos.esa.int/web/planck*

Software

willhandley.co.uk/software

- PolyChord Sole author and maintainer: github.com/PolyChord/PolyChordLite
- anesthetic Principle author and maintainer: github.com/handley-lab/anesthetic
- mcp-handley-lab Principle author and maintainer: github.com/handley-lab/mcp-handley-lab
- blackjax Contributor (nested sampling): github.com/handley-lab/blackjax
- lsbi Principle author and maintainer: github.com/handley-lab/lsbi
- unimpeded Principle author and maintainer: github.com/handley-lab/unimpeded
- fgivenx Sole author and maintainer: github.com/handley-lab/fgivenx
- pyBAMBI Team maintainer: github.com/DarkMachines/pyBAMBI
- MultiNest Maintainer: github.com/farhanferoz/MultiNest
- primordial Sole author and maintainer: github.com/williamjameshandley/primordial
- ModeCode Maintainer: modecode.org
- Open source
 - scipy: Weighted kernel density estimation in `scipy.stats.gaussian_kde`
 - matplotlib: Vertical slider in `matplotlib.widgets.Slider`

Interaction with industry

- PolyChord 2017–: Founded start-up company PolyChord Ltd. to bring Bayesian methods & tools from cosmology to Machine Learning & Biotech industries: polychord.co.uk
- CMAM 2017–2023: Consulted for finance spin-out on Bayesian algorithmic trading
- AnyVision 2019–2020: Worked collaboratively as part of STFC grant to apply Bayesian sparse reconstruction to facial recognition
- Shell 2016: Worked with department postdocs in the department applying nested sampling to geophysics

Interaction with Government

- 2025 Invited participant: "11 Years of Resistance: Advancing the UK–Ukraine Strategic Partnership" conference, Houses of Parliament
- 2025 AI consult to the UK Technology Advisor (Dave Smith)
- 2024 Workshop participant in national security resilience in the future electromagnetic environment
- 2020– DSTL: Consult for government defence research using Bayesian inference

In the media

- 2022 **Cavendish Laboratory News**, *What can astrophysical data-intensive science do beyond the Universe?*, PolyChord, the next generation optimisation technology
<https://www.phy.cam.ac.uk/news/what-can-astrophysical-data-intensive-science-do-beyond-universe-polychord-next-generation>
- 2022 **BBC Radio 4**, *The Third Degree*, Astrophysics Don
"Students vs Dons" BBC radio quiz aired July 2022
- 2022 **KICC annual report**, *Bringing astrostatistics back to Earth*
kicc.cam.ac.uk/aboutus/kicc-annual-reports
- 2020 **Quanta Magazine**, *Modified gravity in cosmology led by Will Barker*
quantamagazine.org/why-is-the-universe-expanding-so-fast-20200427/
- 2019 **KICC annual report**, *Compromise-free Bayesian cosmology & AstroHack week*

Computer skills

Programming MPI parallelisation, C++, FORTRAN, Mathematica, Maple, Python, JAX
Computing Unix, Bash, zsh, vim, git, svn, L^AT_EX, TikZ, VMs, CI, LLMs (Claude, Gemini, GPT, Ollama)
OS Arch Linux & HPC supercomputing (Experienced), Windows & OSX (Familiar)

References

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